TRISHULAN INDUSTRIAL CONNECT

PLATFORM FEATURES GUIDE

A practical comparison of five kinds of business platforms, their tools, dashboards, support options and sample workflows.

Prepared as a neutral feature guide

The five platforms are identified only as Platform A through Platform E. Product and company names are intentionally omitted from the report body. Interface drawings are original examples designed to explain common options; they are not screenshots of the live services.

PLATFORM A Indian supplier discovery	**PLATFORM B** Global wholesale sourcing
PLATFORM C Indian B2B marketplace	**PLATFORM D** Trade data intelligence
PLATFORM E SME digital presence + sourcing	**REPORT DATE** 30 September 2026

How to use this guide

This report explains what each platform type lets a buyer or seller do, what information appears on typical screens, how a sample dashboard could be used, and how to seek support. Feature availability can depend on country, account role, subscription, and current platform rules.

Important: The charts and interface examples in this PDF are illustrative. The data values are fictional and do not describe actual site performance. Support phone numbers and plans can change; the support section therefore emphasizes the available channels and the official source locations to re-check before use.

CAPABILITY	A	B	C	D	E
Product/supplier discovery	Strong	Strong	Strong	Trade-record search	Supplier directory
Buyer requirement / RFQ	Requirement post	RFQ marketplace	Requirement post	No transaction RFQ	Structured RFQ
Seller catalogue/profile	Yes	Storefront	Online showroom	Company profile data	B2B site/catalogue
Order/payment transaction	Usually contact-led	Platform order tools	Service-dependent	Not a marketplace	May enable checkout
Shipment / market analytics	Limited marketplace context	Platform/order context	Trade leads	Core purpose	Sourcing context
Best fit	Domestic leads	Cross-border sourcing	India B2B leads	Export/import research	Digital SME presence

Quick distinction

Platforms A and C are lead-generation marketplaces. Platform B adds international sourcing and order-protection workflows. Platform D is a trade-intelligence product used to investigate shipments and markets. Platform E emphasizes a business web presence, structured catalogue and procurement connections.

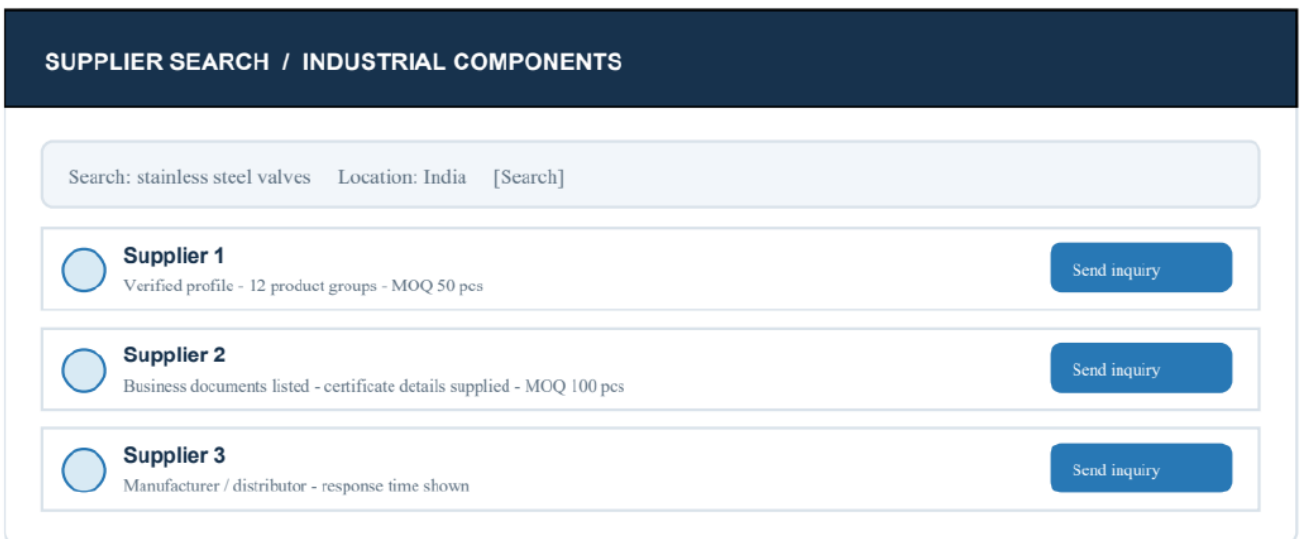
PLATFORM A | Indian supplier discovery marketplace

Search supplier listings, inspect business profiles and product catalogues, send inquiries, or post a buying requirement. Suppliers can create a company listing, upload products, manage inquiries and purchase optional visibility services.

Options and features

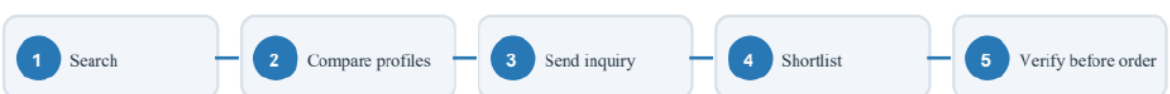
- Search by item, supplier or location
- Compare descriptions, price indications, MOQ and contact options
- Send an inquiry to one or more suppliers
- Post buyer requirement and receive responses
- Seller profile, photos, product range and inquiry management
- Optional enhanced visibility or verification services may be offered

Feature example: what the screen can show



Example use: A maintenance buyer searches for a 2-inch stainless steel valve, selects the delivery region, compares three suppliers and asks each for grade certificate, price, MOQ and delivery time.

Typical user journey

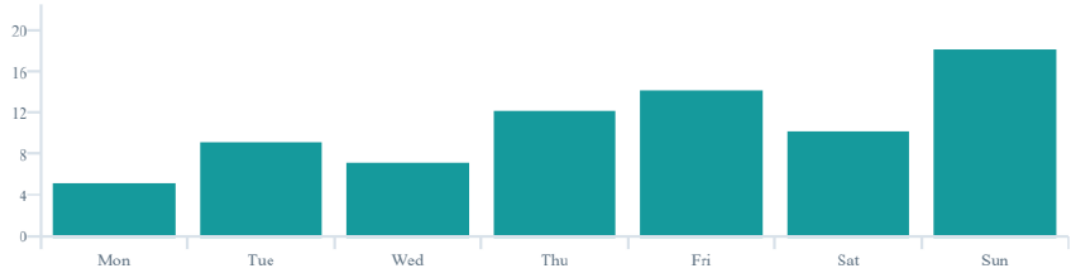


Dashboard ideas for this platform type

Illustrative activity dashboard

Sample activity counts only; actual dashboards and available metrics vary by plan.

NEW LEADS	RESPONDED	OPEN RFQs
24	18	7



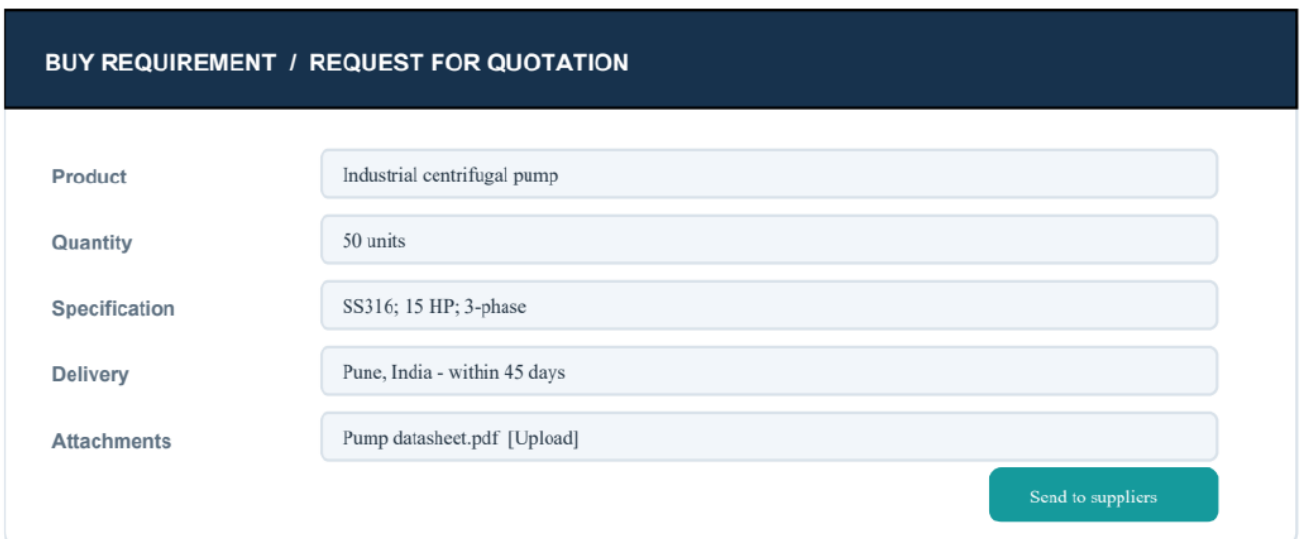
PLATFORM B | International wholesale sourcing marketplace

Connect buyers and manufacturers across countries. Product search, supplier storefronts, direct messages, RFQs, order workflows and eligible protected-payment programs can support cross-border purchases.

Options and features

- Search by product, manufacturer, image or category
- Use RFQ to invite multiple suppliers to quote
- Review MOQ, customization, lead time and shipping terms
- Message suppliers and share files/specifications
- Use eligible platform order/payment protection
- Seller storefront, catalogue, inquiry and RFQ workbench

Feature example: what the screen can show



Example use: A distributor needs 5,000 custom brackets. The buyer attaches a drawing and requests material grade, unit price at multiple volumes, tooling fee, production time, sample availability and FOB/CIF options.

Typical user journey

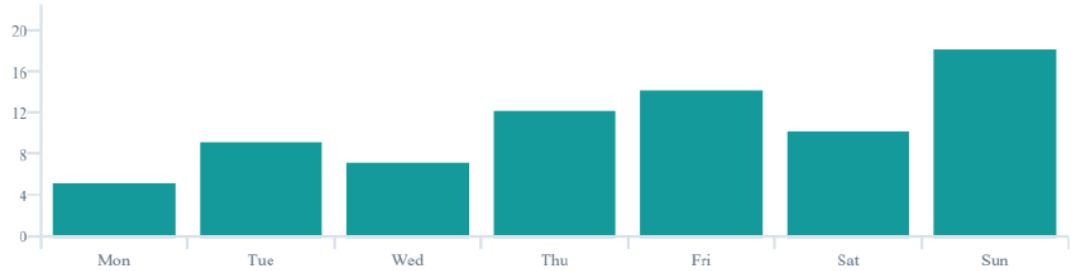


Dashboard ideas for this platform type

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PLATFORM C | Indian B2B marketplace and trade-lead portal

A marketplace for supplier and product search in India, with buyer requirement posting, supplier inquiries, online product catalogues, trade leads and business services.

Options and features

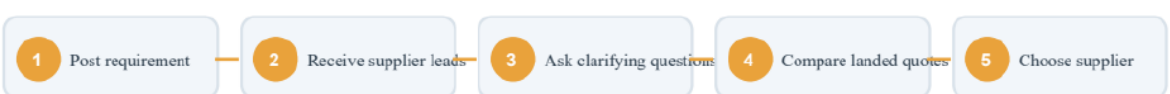
- Search products, services and Indian suppliers
- Post a buy requirement and receive supplier responses
- Contact multiple sellers before making a decision
- Supplier registration, company profile and product showroom
- Manage buyer inquiries in seller account
- Trade leads, distributor discovery, trade shows and add-on services

Feature example: what the screen can show



Example use: A food processor needs 10,000 laminated pouches. It posts size, material, print design, food-contact requirement, quantity and destination; suppliers provide quotations.

Typical user journey

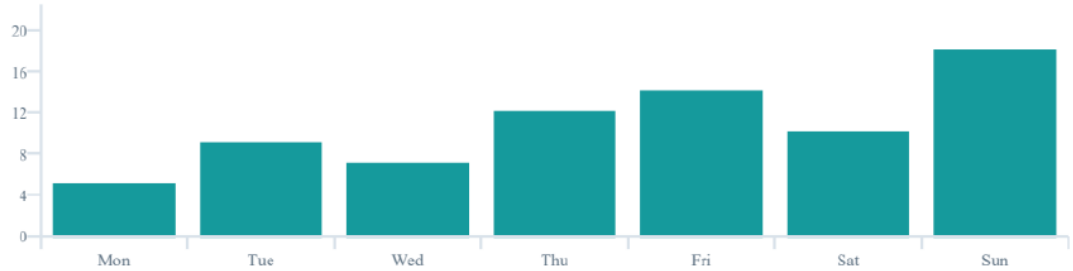


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PLATFORM D | Import-export intelligence and trade-data platform

A research workspace rather than a product marketplace. Users query shipment records, analyze buyer/supplier relationships, compare markets and create alerts. Access to detailed records and contacts is often subscription-gated.

Options and features

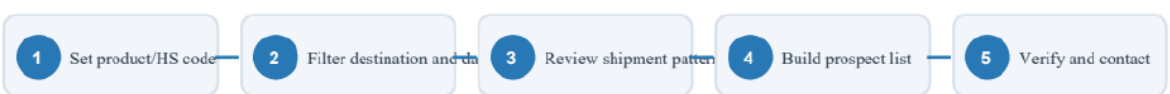
- Search by product, HS code, buyer, supplier or country
- Filter by time, shipment frequency, geography and trade role
- Inspect company profile and shipment history
- Analyze products, buyers, suppliers and competitor activity
- View trends in charts, dashboards and reports
- Set alerts and export selected research results

Feature example: what the screen can show



Example use: A pump exporter identifies a target country, searches pump-related product codes and shipment activity, checks repeat importers and supplier relationships, then validates prospects independently before outreach.

Typical user journey

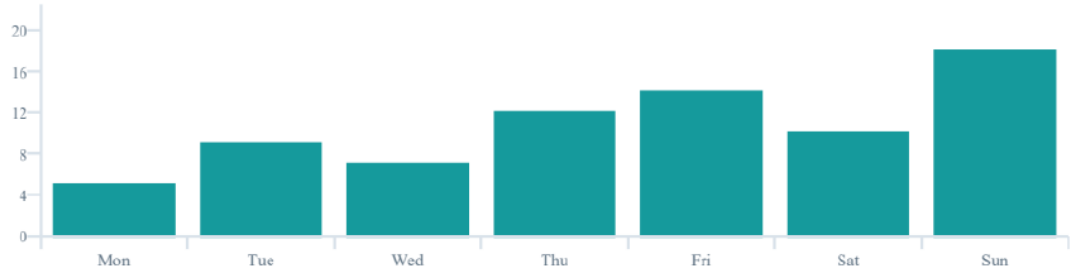


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PLATFORM E | SME digital-presence and sourcing network

A business profile and structured catalogue can be paired with a website/storefront, buyer inquiries, RFQs, supplier discovery, and sometimes managed procurement support.

Options and features

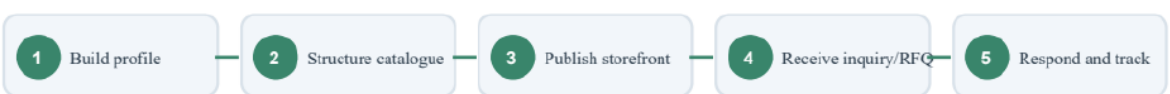
- Create company profile and digital business card
- Build product catalogue with specs, MOQ and certifications
- Share a hosted business website or storefront
- Appear in a supplier marketplace or partner ecosystem
- Receive and respond to buyer inquiries and RFQs
- Buyer tools may include supplier search, quote comparison and assisted sourcing

Feature example: what the screen can show



Example use: A small component maker builds a catalogue with product dimensions, materials, tolerances, certifications and MOQ. A buyer searches the catalogue and submits a structured RFQ.

Typical user journey

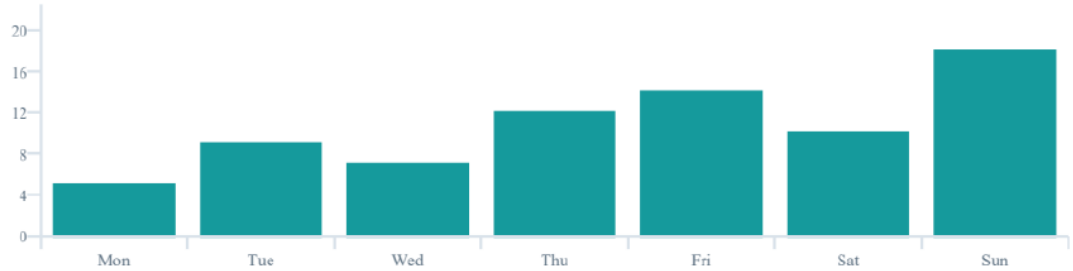


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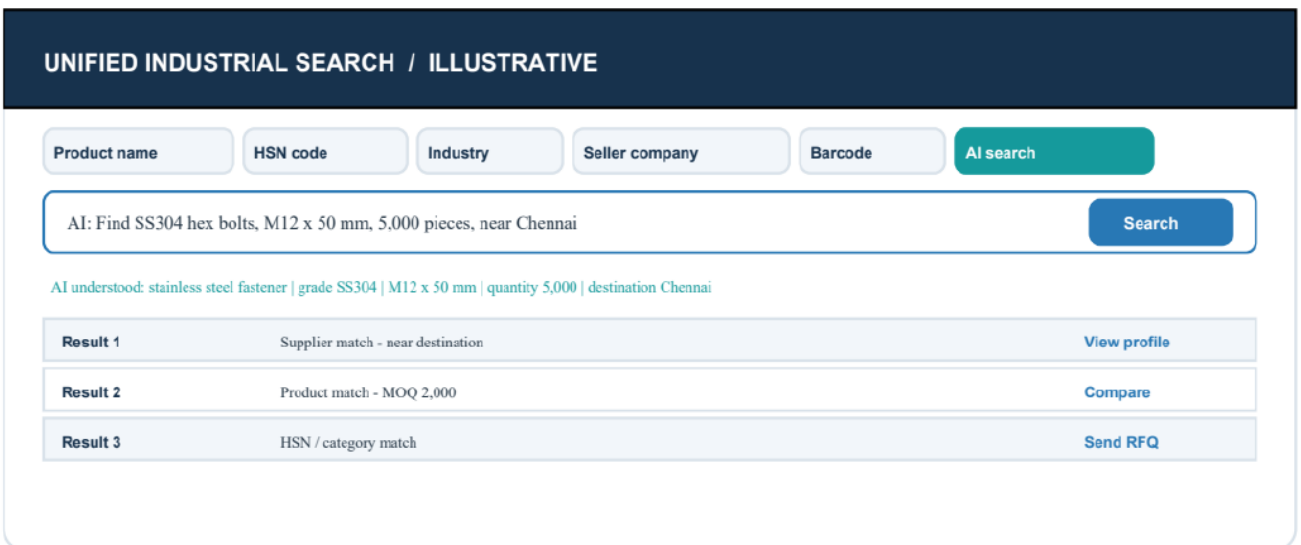


Proposed feature expansion for Trishulan Industrial Connect

The following modules extend the five-platform comparison into a single practical business service. They are proposed product features, not claims about features already operating on a live website. The goal is to help industrial buyers and suppliers discover each other, compare options and complete the next step with clear information.

Unified search bar and AI discovery

Place a prominent search bar across the website and app. Let users choose what they are searching for or enter a natural-language request and let AI help interpret it. Search must work for products and suppliers, not only general keywords.



- Search by product or part name, model, technical specification, material, grade, dimensions and application.

- Search by HSN code, with a code lookup and product-description suggestions; let the user confirm the correct classification rather than silently deciding it.

- Browse by industry and subcategory, then filter by country, city, supplier type, manufacturer/distributor, MOQ, certifications, capacity and delivery region.

- Search seller company name or profile name and find the business profile, product catalogue and public contact/inquiry route.

- Use barcode scan or typed barcode/GTIN when available to match a product or inventory item; offer a manual product-name fallback.

- AI search can interpret requests such as “find 5,000 SS304 M12 bolts near Chennai” into product, grade, size, quantity and location filters. Show the interpreted fields so the user can correct them.

- AI can suggest synonyms, relevant HSN candidates and related industries, but show why results match, avoid inventing specifications and ask a follow-up question when a key detail is missing.

Example: a buyer scans a package barcode, or switches to AI search and enters a free-text industrial requirement. Search returns matching catalogue products and seller profiles with visible match reasons, MOQ and location. The buyer edits the parsed filters, compares suppliers and sends a structured RFQ.

Additional market-ready marketplace features

Add workflow tools that make supplier discovery more actionable and help both sides move from a match to a completed order. The proposed approach uses the common digital-sourcing pattern of structured requirements, supplier matching, side-by-side quotes and optional assisted sourcing. Shipment booking and tracking are additional proposed modules described below.

BUYER RFQ MATCHING / ILLUSTRATIVE COMPARE VIEW

Need: SS304 M12 hex bolts | 5,000 pcs | Chennai | delivery within 30 days

Supplier	Match reason	MOQ / ETA	Quote status
Supplier 1	Grade + size match; near location	2,000 / 12 days	Quote received
Supplier 2	Product match; cert listed	5,000 / 21 days	Clarification
Supplier 3	Industry + location match	1,000 / 8 days	Invited

Buyer can compare price, payment, freight, certifications and response completeness on one RFQ thread.

- Explain recommendations with match reasons such as exact product spec, location, MOQ, capacity, certifications listed or delivery window. Let buyers tune the matching factors.

- Use shared RFQ workspaces where buyers and invited suppliers can exchange messages, files, quote versions, clarifications, sample requests and next steps.

- Provide quote comparison with currency, tax, freight, Incoterm, payment terms, validity, MOQ and delivery date aligned in common fields.

- Give sellers a simple lead inbox, reminders, team assignments, saved replies, catalogue analytics and follow-up tracking.

- Support multi-language product descriptions, unit conversion and currency display for cross-border buyers; preserve original supplier values and state conversion time.

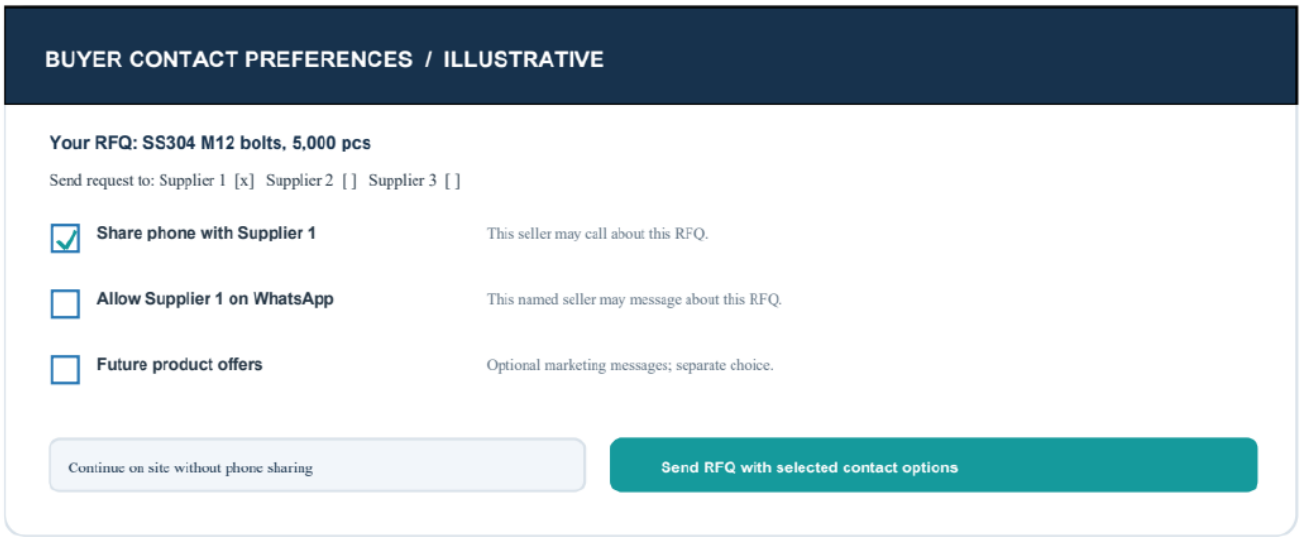
- Allow post-transaction feedback only for completed or evidenced platform transactions, with moderation, response rights and transparent review rules.

- Offer assisted sourcing for complex or urgent requirements with clear service scope, supplier validation steps, charges and buyer approval before commitments.

Example: a buyer posts one RFQ and receives three quote responses. The compare view explains why each supplier matched and places price, MOQ, delivery, documentation and freight into the same format. The buyer asks one clarification in the shared thread, then requests a transport quote after selecting the supplier.

Buyer lead sharing, WhatsApp and company database

When a buyer is interested in a product, capture a lead through an inquiry or RFQ form. The buyer phone number must not be disclosed just because the person searched or viewed a product. Ask the buyer to choose which named sellers may receive it and whether each seller may contact them on WhatsApp. With permission, deliver the lead through the seller website inbox and send the seller a WhatsApp Business notification. Keep website messaging available. Use a separate optional choice for future marketing.



- Show the exact product/RFQ and selected seller names before the buyer submits. Explain what contact information each seller will receive and for what purpose.

- Keep permission to share the number on the site separate from permission for the named seller to contact the buyer on WhatsApp, and separate both from future offers. Save the consent wording, time, channel, seller IDs and RFQ reference.

- Create a lead record in Trishulan Industrial Connect's company-managed database/CRM: buyer ID, requested product, quantity, location, selected seller IDs, permitted contact channels, status, timestamps and source page. Store a phone number only when needed and permitted.

- Send each seller only the lead fields and contact method permitted for that seller. The seller receives it in its site inbox and, if configured, a WhatsApp Business notification. Do not include the phone number in a notification unless the buyer specifically agreed to that sharing route.

- Sellers must not browse the full buyer database or reuse another seller's lead. Apply role-based access, encryption, audit logs, backup/retention rules, correction/deletion request handling and a way to withdraw future messaging consent.

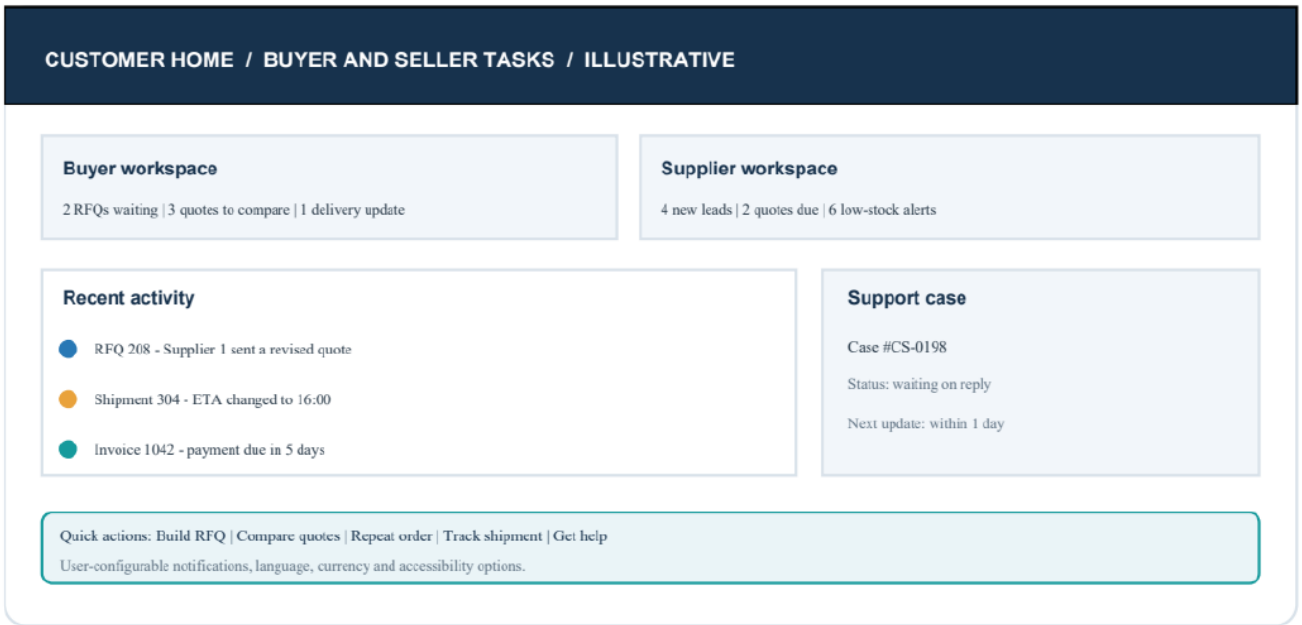
- If a seller initiates WhatsApp contact, collect a clear opt-in that identifies that seller and the RFQ purpose; honor stop/block requests and current messaging rules.

- Provide a privacy notice before collection describing data collected, purpose, sharing, retention, user choices and support/complaint route. Have qualified privacy counsel review the final design for applicable Indian and other market rules.

Example: a buyer searches for a product but their phone stays private. They submit an RFQ and select two named suppliers. They choose to share their phone through the site and separately allow those sellers to WhatsApp about that RFQ. Each supplier gets the lead in its site inbox and a WhatsApp alert; the phone number is revealed only through the allowed contact route. The CRM records the choices and routes the lead only to those suppliers.

Customer requirements and experience features

Design around the tasks customers need to finish: find the right product, get a comparable quote, contact the right person, track the order and resolve problems. Give buyers and sellers clear next steps on both desktop and mobile. The features below are proposed based on the product direction in this guide.



Buyer requirements

- Fast signup and onboarding that remembers preferences, language, currency, delivery locations and saved business details.

- RFQ builder that helps buyers describe a need with text, photos, drawings or a spreadsheet, checks missing specification fields and lets the buyer edit before sending.

- Compare supplier offers on a consistent view: specification match, price and currency, MOQ, taxes, freight, delivery date, payment terms, certifications and quote expiry.

- Shortlist suppliers, save products/searches, share a shortlist with teammates and set alerts for new quotes, price changes, stock availability or shipment events.

- Request a sample, clarification or meeting; keep the conversation and version history connected to the RFQ and order.

- See order and shipment milestones, expected delivery, required documents, invoice/payment status and a way to report a delay or damaged/short shipment.

Seller requirements

- A lead inbox that prioritizes qualified requests, shows response deadlines and avoids duplicate entry from buyer inquiry to quote/order.

- Quick quote templates and catalogue reuse, with editable line items, volume breaks, validity, tax/freight terms and attachments.

- Tools to show available capacity, lead time, service region, minimum order and temporary out-of-stock status so matching is more accurate.

- Customer relationship tools for reminders, team ownership, notes, repeat orders and buyer-request history, with consent-aware contact access.

- Analytics that focus on qualified RFQs, response time, quote completion, order conversion, repeat buyers and reasons for losing a deal.

Shared customer service requirements

- One support centre with searchable guides, ticket submission, attachment upload, case number, status, owner, expected response time and escalation route.

- Notifications that customers can control by category and channel: website, email, SMS or WhatsApp. Do not mix service updates with marketing permission.

- Accessible, mobile-friendly screens, plain-language errors, saved drafts and human help for account, KYC, quote, shipment, payment and insurance issues.

- After a completed order, collect structured feedback about product fit, delivery and service; allow a reply and dispute process, and show how feedback is moderated.

Example customer journey: the buyer uploads a drawing and quantity; the RFQ assistant identifies missing tolerances and asks a follow-up. Two chosen suppliers return quotes. A comparison screen highlights differences, then the buyer requests a sample from one supplier. After acceptance, the dashboard shows order, shipment, invoice and support status in one place. The seller sees a lead reminder and can turn its quote into an order without re-entering details.

Customer-facing acceptance checks

A feature is ready when the buyer can understand the next step, correct AI-parsed details, compare offers without hidden assumptions, control contact preferences and find the status of an open request. A seller can see only its assigned leads, respond without duplicate data entry and track whether the buyer has received the reply. A support request always has a case ID and visible status.

1. Industrial analyzer

Purpose: help a buyer, manufacturer, exporter or distributor understand product demand, supply availability and market movement before making a sourcing or sales decision. The analyzer should combine product search, category and specification filters, market indicators, company discovery and saved alerts.

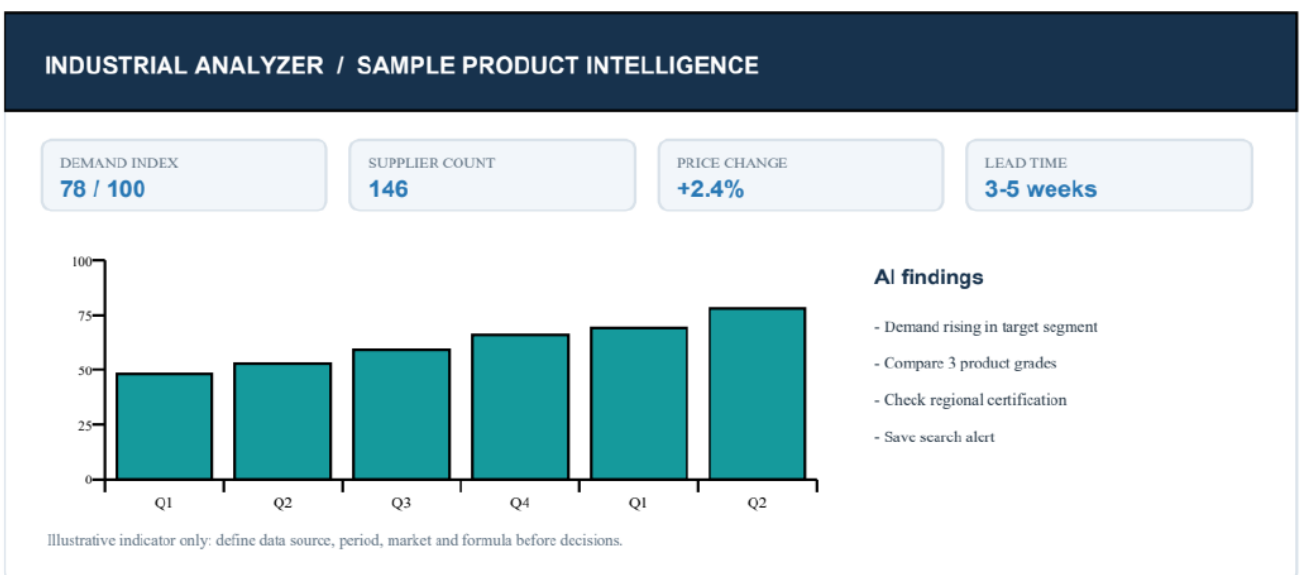
- Search products by name, grade, material, application, specification or HS code.

- Show national and international market coverage, supplier counts, demand direction, indicative lead times and trade activity.

- Compare regions and product grades; separate manufacturers, distributors and service providers where information supports it.

- Create saved searches and alerts for new suppliers, buyer requirements, price movements or market activity.

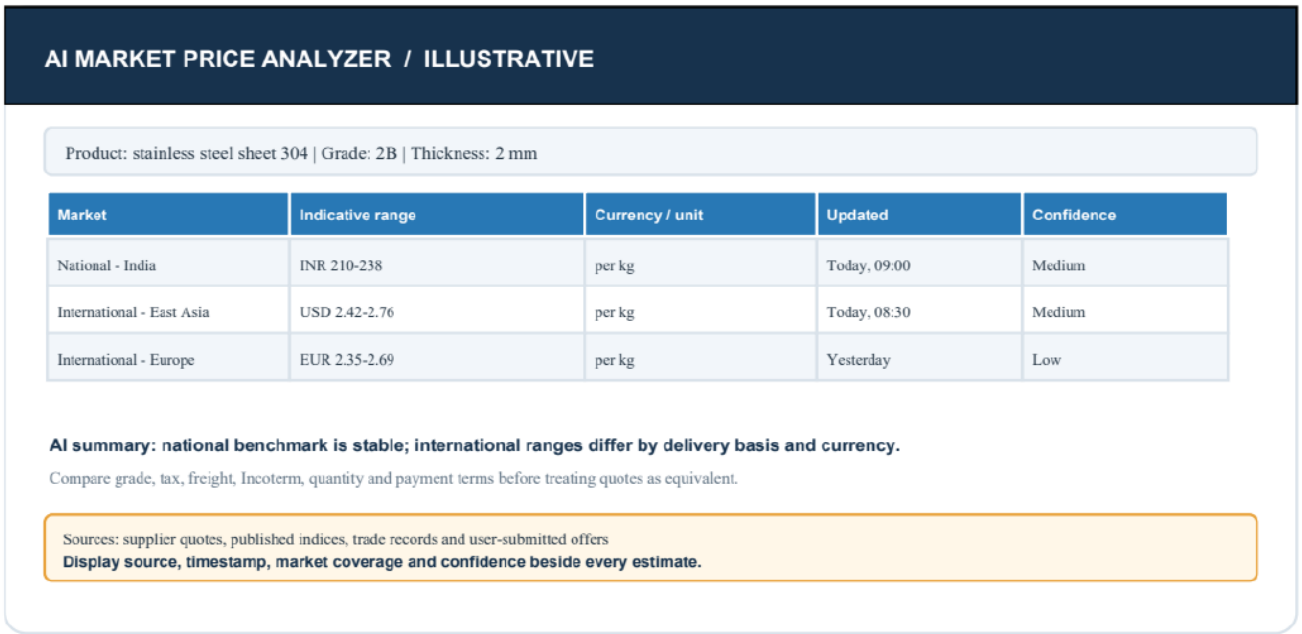
- Display each metric definition, source type, coverage, date range and confidence.



Example: a buyer searching for industrial pump components reviews demand by region, sees supplier availability and likely lead times, saves a target market, then opens matched supplier profiles. All scores are illustrative until backed by real data sources.

2. AI-assisted daily market price analyzer

Purpose: let a user search for a product and see a dated, comparable price range for the national market and selected international markets. AI can normalize product descriptions and summarize observed prices, but the screen must distinguish observed quotes from estimated benchmarks.



- Search by product name, specification, grade, size, quantity, origin and destination.
- Show national benchmark and international market views in local currency and a normalized comparison currency.
- Record whether a price is a supplier quote, published index, trade declaration, marketplace listing or AI-estimated range.
- Show update time, source period, sample size, market coverage, taxes/freight basis and confidence next to each result.
- Let users compare EXW/FOB/CIF or delivery basis, quantity breaks, MOQ, payment terms, freight and taxes before deciding.
- Offer watchlists and daily/weekly alerts when a comparable benchmark crosses a selected threshold.

Example: a user searches “SS316 sheet, 2 mm, 2B finish.” The analyzer shows separate India, East Asia and Europe ranges, with currencies, unit, timestamp and source labels. AI explains that the numbers are not directly comparable until grade, tax, freight, quantity and delivery basis match. The sample values in the drawing are fictional.

Price data controls and trust labels

A daily price panel needs a dependable feed strategy. It should label delayed data, stale data, low sample counts and model estimates. It should never present an AI-generated number as an official market price. Keep source attribution, timestamp, currency conversion time and user-submitted quote status visible. Provide a way to report an incorrect listing and a record of the assumptions used in each comparison.

Business services connected to the marketplace

3. Account registration, KYC and business setup

Add KYC to account registration so buyers and suppliers can establish an account, verify contact details and submit the information needed for the account type. The required checks should be selected for the service and jurisdiction, and completed through an authorized verification provider or appropriate official process. The platform should explain the purpose, request consent, collect only necessary information, protect uploaded documents, show status and provide a way to correct or appeal a review result. Do not imply that a KYC badge guarantees product quality, payment safety or legal compliance.

Proposed KYC process

- Create account with work email/mobile and password; verify contact through OTP or confirmation link.

- Select buyer, supplier, transporter, service provider or individual account; collect only the profile details needed for that role.

- For business accounts, provide legal/trading name, country/state, registration or tax identifier where applicable, address and authorized representative details.

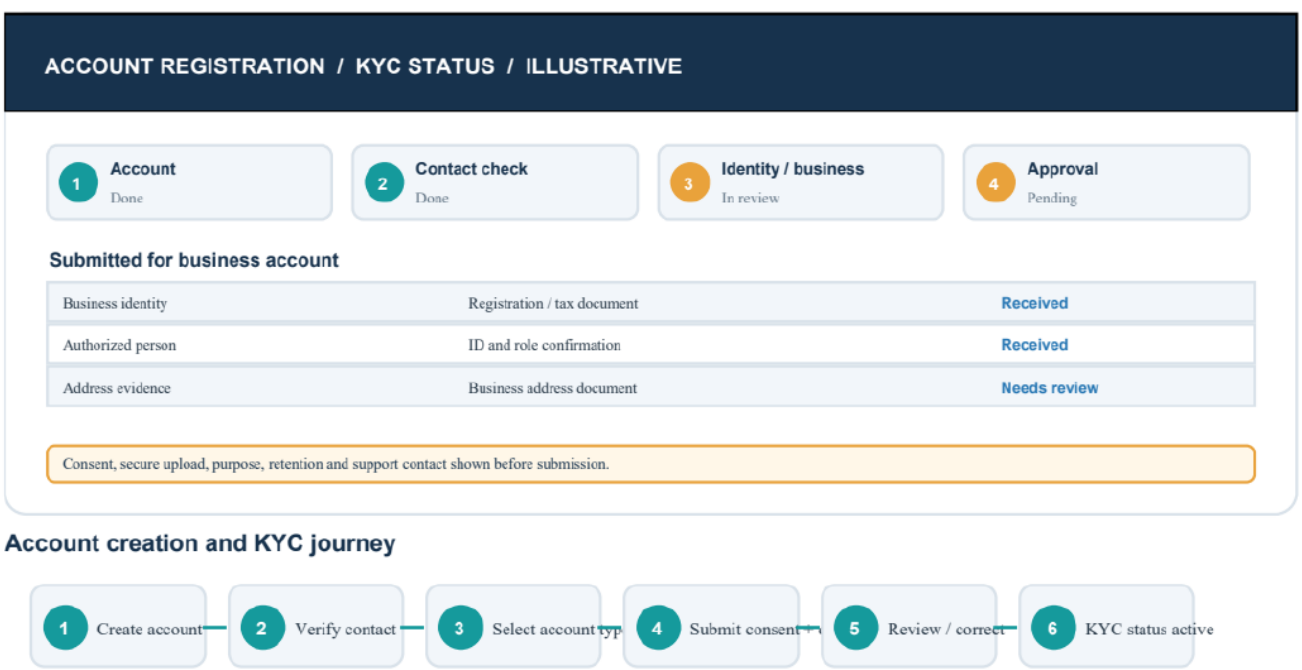
- Upload required documents using secure upload; show which document is requested, why it is needed, accepted formats and expiry rules.

- Capture consent and privacy notice before any identity check; state who processes the data, purpose, retention period and support route.

- Run document and account review; show statuses such as Not started, In progress, Action needed, Under review, Verified or Not approved.

- If action is needed, explain the missing or unreadable item and allow a corrected resubmission. Provide an appeal/support path.

- Use risk-based access: disclose which marketplace actions need verification, and do not block unrelated basic browsing without a stated reason.



Account creation and KYC journey

Example: a new industrial supplier registers with a work email, confirms its phone, selects a business-seller account and uploads the business document and authorized-person evidence requested for its region. The dashboard shows "Address evidence - needs review," explains the issue, and offers a secure re-upload. The supplier can see what features are

available while review is pending.

Registration and compliance guidance

Provide a guided service directory and checklist for business formation and registrations. The platform can explain common steps, gather user information, track documents and connect users with authorized professionals or government portals. Requirements depend on legal form, state, sector and export activity; the service should show that users must confirm current requirements with the relevant authority or qualified advisor.

- Business setup checklist by business type, state and industry.
- Document organizer for identity, address, tax and company records, with expiry reminders where relevant.
- Step tracker: not started, documents pending, submitted, clarification needed, complete.
- Appointment or referral request to a verified accountant, company secretary, licensing consultant or other service provider.
- Links to official registration portals, document lists, fee information and application status checks where available.
- Clear separation between general guidance and legal/tax advice; do not promise approval or registration outcomes.

Example feature image: guided registration checklist

BUSINESS REGISTRATION / ILLUSTRATIVE SCREEN

Task	Needed item	Status	Next action
Business type	Choose legal form	Complete	Review choice
Identity records	Owner ID/address	Upload pending	Add secure files
Tax registration	Business details	Not started	View official steps
Advisor support	Appointment request	Optional	Request callback

Sample checklist only; requirements depend on jurisdiction and business type.

Example: a new industrial supplier selects “sole proprietor” and its state. The platform produces a checklist, lets the user upload required documents to a secure account, and offers an appointment request with a listed advisor. A progress card shows which steps remain.

4. Transport and shipment support

Connect buyers and sellers to transport providers and shipment services. Make route, vehicle/container type, pickup, delivery, load dimensions, weight, handling needs, insurance and timing visible before a booking request.

- Request road, rail, air, sea or multimodal transport quotations based on route and cargo details.
- Compare provider quotes on estimated price, transit time, capacity, included services and exclusions.
- Track shipment milestones: quote requested, booked, picked up, in transit, delivered, exception.
- Share shipment documents and proof of delivery among the buyer, seller and transporter.
- Show whether charges are estimates or confirmed; explain demurrage, detention, customs and accessorial costs.

Example feature image: transport quote comparison

TRANSPORT OPTIONS / ILLUSTRATIVE SCREEN

Provider	Route / service	Estimate	Status
Carrier A	Pune to Chennai / road	INR 28,500	Quote received
Carrier B	Pune to Chennai / road	INR 31,200	2-day transit
Carrier C	Pune to Chennai / rail	INR 24,900	Capacity check
Shipment	Pickup 4 Oct	Tracking ID	Awaiting booking

Illustrative quotes; verify cargo dimensions, insurance, exclusions and final charges.

Example: a seller enters pallet count, dimensions, gross weight, pickup city and delivery pin code. Transport providers return comparable quotes, while both trading parties can view the assigned transporter and milestone status.

Expanded shipment and transport management

Extend the transport quote feature into a shared shipment workspace. The inspiration is the buyer-led sourcing pattern of supplier discovery, structured RFQs, quote comparison and optional assisted procurement. The shipment control tower below is a proposed Trishulan extension; the public reference materials reviewed do not establish that the reference sourcing platform provides this complete transport-management feature set.

SHIPMENT CONTROL TOWER / SAMPLE WORKSPACE

ACTIVE SHIPMENTS	ON TIME	NEEDS ACTION
18	92%	2

Shipment TRC-2048 | Pune to Chennai | Road



Last event 10:42 | Checkpoint scanned | Estimated arrival tomorrow 16:00

Map location and ETA depend on carrier data; manual update option available.

Shared shipment folder

- Rate confirmation - saved
- Packing list - uploaded
- Transport document - issued
- Proof of delivery - pending

Exception alert: destination delay +6 hours

Notify buyer + seller | assign owner | request carrier update | record resolution

- Rate shopping and booking: compare road, rail, air, sea and multimodal options by route, weight/volume, equipment, inclusions, transit time, cutoff and rate expiry. Keep estimated and confirmed charges distinct.

- Load planning: capture dimensions, stackability, loading equipment, dangerous-goods or temperature needs, pickup windows, delivery appointments, multiple stops and partial loads. Offer full-load versus part-load comparison.

- Carrier and vehicle checks: collect provider credentials and relevant vehicle/driver documents, availability, insurance evidence, service lanes and performance history; show exactly what has been checked and when.

- Booking lifecycle: request quote, approve quote, book, assign carrier/vehicle, confirm pickup, record transit milestones, receive at destination and close after delivery. Preserve the rate confirmation and change history.

- Live visibility: use carrier API/GPS events where available, with manual check-in fallback. Show last event time, location confidence, ETA, delay alerts, geofence or milestone updates and the next responsible contact.

- Shared shipment room: buyer, seller, transporter and approved staff see the same shipment ID, contacts, booking terms, status, messages and document versions, with role-based permissions.

- Digital documents: organize quote, booking confirmation, invoice, packing list, transport receipt, applicable regulatory documents, delivery photos, signature or OTP proof of delivery. Provide a correction and missing-document queue.

- Exception and claims handling: report delay, damage, shortage, failed pickup or refusal; assign an owner, preserve evidence, notify parties and track resolution or insurance claim status.

- Freight reconciliation: compare quoted rate with final carrier invoice, accessorial charges, taxes and proof of delivery; flag differences for review before marking a shipment financially closed.

- Shipment alerts and analytics: send email/SMS/WhatsApp notifications by user preference; report lane cost, on-time delivery, delay causes, carrier response and cost per unit/kg. Carbon estimates may be shown only with the method and data source.

Example end-to-end shipment: after the buyer accepts a supplier quote, the seller converts the order into a shipment request with pallet dimensions and delivery window. The system compares carriers, the buyer approves a quote, the selected provider confirms the vehicle, pickup and delivery events update the shared timeline, and a photo/signature proof of delivery closes the shipment. An extra-charge alert sends the final invoice to a review queue.

Shipment lifecycle



Integration and service limits

Use carrier, courier, freight-forwarder and visibility-provider integrations only after commercial and technical agreements are in place. Where live tracking or instant rates are unavailable, label the estimate and provide manual updates. Regulatory documents and insurance options must be shown only when applicable and confirmed; the platform should not imply it is the carrier, insurer or customs authority unless it actually holds that role.

5. Packing and packaging support

Help businesses specify product packaging, find packaging suppliers and request packaging quotations. The platform can capture product fragility, dimensions, quantity, export route, stacking, moisture and regulatory needs.

- Packaging product directory for cartons, crates, pallets, drums, liners, labels and protective materials.

- Requirement form for dimensions, weight, material, print, food contact, export, reuse and sustainability preferences.

- Compare suppliers by price break, MOQ, sample, production time, certificate and delivery cost.

- Provide a packing checklist and document/photo record before dispatch.

- Offer standard examples but prompt the buyer to confirm product safety and applicable rules.

Example feature image: packaging supplier comparison

PACKAGING REQUIREMENTS / ILLUSTRATIVE SCREEN

Option	Suitable use	MOQ / timing	Buyer action
Export crate	Heavy machinery	10 / 7 days	Request sample
Moisture barrier	Sea shipment	100 / 5 days	Compare spec
Pallet + straps	Warehouse load	20 / 3 days	Add to request
Pack checklist	Photo evidence	Per shipment	Upload photos

Sample choices only; confirm load, route, product rules and final packing design.

Example: an exporter selects “machinery part, 80 kg, sea freight.” A checklist suggests requesting corrosion protection, immobilization, lifting marks and moisture barrier details; packaging providers quote based on dimensions and destination.

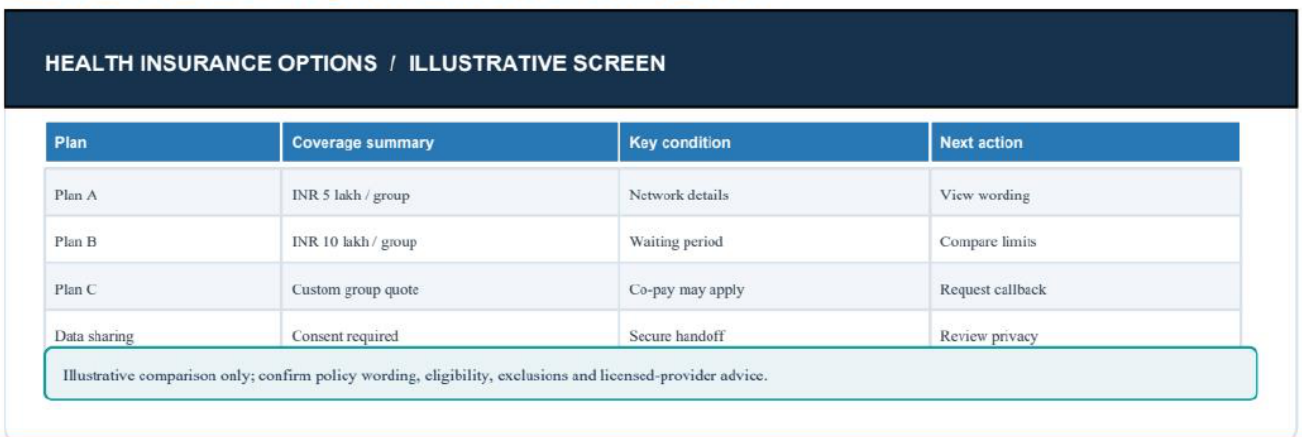
Insurance and buyer-supplier connection

6. Health insurance access

Add a benefits area that helps business owners and employees discover health insurance options through licensed insurers, brokers or benefits administrators. Health insurance is distinct from cargo insurance and should have its own clearly named area. The platform should explain eligibility, coverage, exclusions, waiting periods, claims process, renewal and privacy before the user submits personal information.

- Choose whether the user is an individual, family, employee group or business buyer.
- Compare insurer/provider options by coverage amount, network, waiting period, exclusions, co-pay and premium basis.
- Request a callback or quote from an appropriately licensed provider; do not represent AI summaries as personalized insurance advice.
- Provide a secure consent-led handoff and protect sensitive health and identity information.
- Offer a separate cargo/transit insurance referral option for shipments, clearly distinguished from health cover.

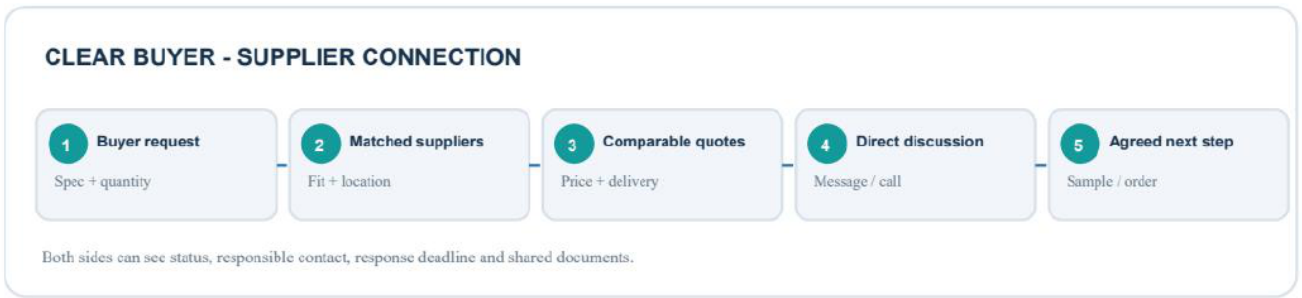
Example feature image: health cover comparison



Example: a small manufacturer selects "group cover for 12 employees," provides only the required non-sensitive basics, compares plan summaries and requests a licensed provider callback. The user sees what data will be shared and can withdraw the request.

7. Clear buyer and supplier connection

Make the buyer and seller journey visible from first search to next action. Each requirement should have one owner, one status, a response deadline and a direct message route. Buyers should see who responded and what is still missing; suppliers should see the specification, quantity, delivery location and required response date.



- Buyer can search suppliers, post a requirement, attach specifications and choose who can view it.
- Matching should explain why a supplier was suggested: product match, location, capacity, certification or prior response.
- Both parties receive a shared RFQ thread with messages, quote versions, attachments and timestamps.
- Buyer can compare quotes on the same template and request clarification without losing the history.

- The platform can support sample request, meeting/call, order handoff and post-delivery feedback.
- A “verified” label must say what was verified and when; it should not guarantee quality or performance.

Suggested end-to-end buyer journey

Discovery to transaction



Suggested seller journey

Profile to repeat business



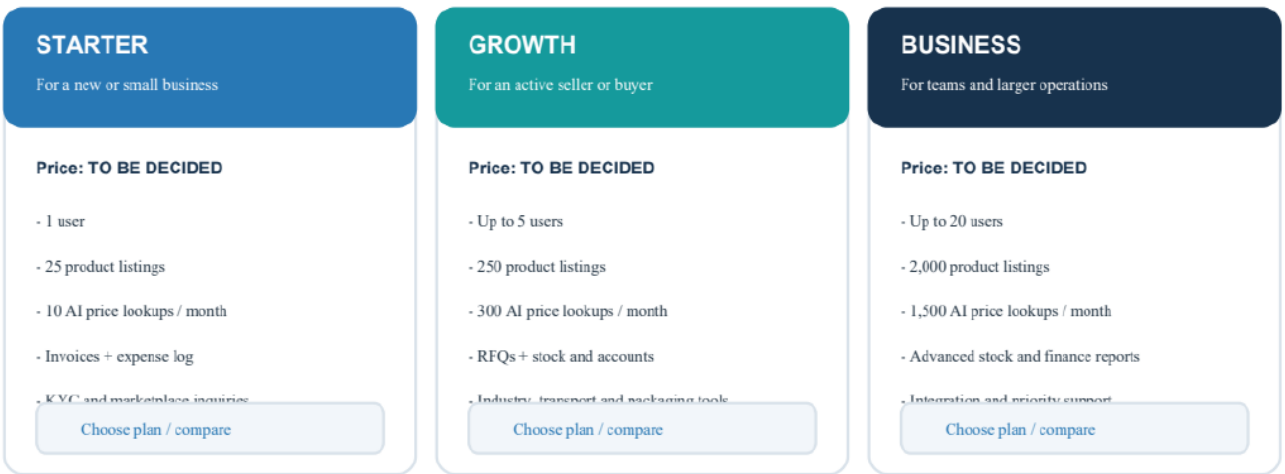
8. One connected services dashboard

Give each user one home screen with role-based shortcuts. Buyers see saved searches, active RFQs, supplier responses, quote comparisons, shipment tracking, registration tasks and service requests. Sellers see profile completeness, product performance, new buyer requests, quotes due, transport/packing requests and optional benefits referrals.

Three subscription plans

Offer three clear tiers so a new business can start simply and expand as its team and workload grow. The feature limits below are planning examples for product design, not existing plan terms. Set the final price and usage quotas after checking hosting, AI/data costs, support load, payment fees and customer feedback.

SUBSCRIPTION PLAN SELECTOR / ILLUSTRATIVE



Illustrative plan comparison

Feature	Starter	Growth	Business
Best for	New/small business	Regular trade activity	Multi-user teams
User seats	1	Up to 5	Up to 20; add-on seats
Product listings	Up to 25	Up to 250	Up to 2,000
Buyer/supplier connection	Search, profile, inquiry	RFQ matching + quote compare	Team assignment + workflow controls
Buyer lead and contact controls	Website inquiry + contact choice	Selected-seller routing + WhatsApp opt-in	CRM roles, consent history and audit log
KYC/account registration	Account KYC status + checklist	Business KYC document tracking	Team/admin controls + audit trail
Industrial analyzer	Basic category snapshot	Regional trends + saved alerts	Advanced dashboards + exports
AI price analyzer	10 lookups/month; dated preview	300 lookups/month; daily market view	1,500 lookups/month; team history
Business services	Registration guide + service directory	Transport/packaging quote requests	Managed service requests + reporting
Shipment management	Shipment IDs and basic status	Rate comparison, booking and milestones	Shared control tower, exceptions and freight reconciliation
Billing / inventory / accounts	Basic invoices and expense log	Stock, purchase orders and reports	Team books, multiple locations and exports
Health insurance access	Provider directory	Compare and request callback	Group-cover referral and team follow-up
Support	Help centre / email ticket	Faster ticket handling	Priority support / onboarding
Subscription price	To be decided	To be decided	Custom / to be decided

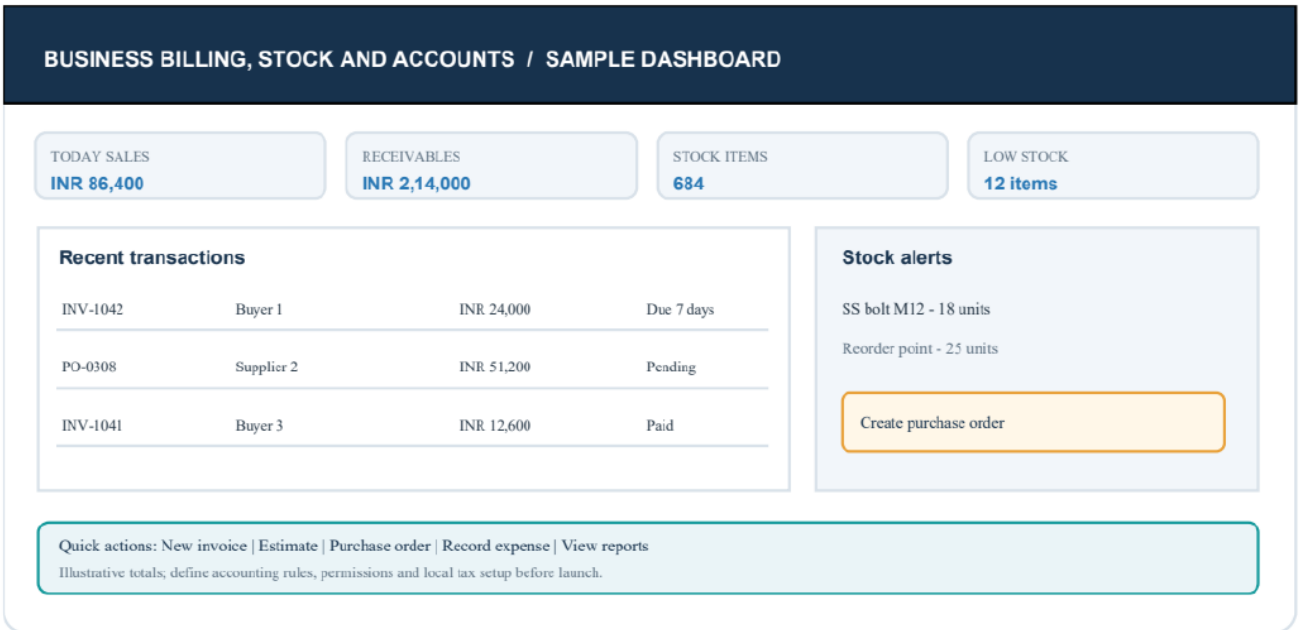
Suggested billing and plan rules

Show monthly and annual billing clearly, with the annual discount stated as an exact amount. Explain taxes, included user seats, listing/search quotas, overage charges, renewal date, trial end, cancellation steps, refund policy and what happens to published listings after downgrade. Let users compare all three plans before checkout and send a receipt with the selected plan and renewal date.

Use the displayed AI price-search quotas as initial planning targets only. Keep a visible usage meter, warn before a limit is reached and show whether a result is cached, delayed or uses a paid data source. Avoid surprise charges.

Small-business billing, inventory and accounts

Add an everyday business operations area for small industrial suppliers, traders and buyers. It should connect marketplace activity to quotations, invoices, purchase orders, stock movements, payment tracking, expense records and reports. The feature set below is inspired by common small-business accounting workflows; it is a proposed Trishulan module, not an existing integration with any other product.



Sales and customer documents

- Create and share estimates, quotations, pro forma invoices, sales orders, delivery challans and invoices. Convert an accepted quotation into an order and then an invoice without retyping line items.

- Record payments received, due dates, partial payments, credit notes, sales returns and customer balance statements. Send payment reminders with a clear invoice reference.

- Customize invoices with business identity, terms, item descriptions, tax fields where applicable and payment instructions. Export or share PDF documents; enable payment links only after a supported provider is connected.

Purchases, inventory and expenses

- Create purchase requests and purchase orders from low-stock alerts or accepted customer orders. Track vendor bills, payments, purchase returns, debit notes and supplier balances.

- Maintain product units, categories, cost/sale price, tax classification, batch/serial details and expiry dates where relevant. Update stock from sales, purchases, returns and adjustments; keep a movement history.

- Set reorder thresholds and alerts, import/export item lists, support barcode entry where hardware is available, and view stock value and ageing.

- Record operating, transport, packing, insurance and service expenses with category, date, supplier, tax evidence and attachment. Separate estimates from confirmed costs.

Accounts, reporting and controls

- Show sales, purchases, receivables, payables, cash/bank entries, day book, expense summaries, stock reports and basic profit/loss and cash-flow views.

- Reconcile payments to invoices and orders. Keep a change log for edits, role-based approvals and exportable records for the business owner or accountant.

- Provide tax-related invoice fields and reports only after the business profile and applicable tax settings are configured. Treat e-invoice, e-way bill and tax-filing connections as optional integrations that must be validated against current official

requirements and user eligibility.

- Offer backups, controlled account access and clear export/retention settings. Reports are management aids and should not be represented as professional accounting or tax advice.

Example workflow: a buyer request becomes a quote; when accepted it becomes a sales order. The supplier reserves stock, raises a purchase order for items below the reorder point, records packing and freight costs, issues an invoice after dispatch, and tracks payment against the invoice. The dashboard updates receivables, stock and sales reports.

Quote to payment



Subscription inclusion by plan

Starter can include basic estimates, invoices, payment status and expense entries. Growth can add inventory, purchase orders, low-stock alerts, customer/supplier balances and richer reports. Business can add multiple users or locations, approval roles, audit history, bulk exports and accounting-system integrations. Final feature limits and prices should be stated in the plan comparison before checkout.

Feature-by-feature explanation

The options below are common across one or more of the five platform types. The example screen elements are intentionally generic and can be used as a checklist when reviewing a live site.

1. Product and supplier search

Search terms, category, location, supplier type, price/MOQ, export market and certification filters.

Example: Example: filter "industrial pump" to manufacturers in India with MOQ under 20 and ISO documentation.

2. Product listing / catalogue

Product title, photos, specifications, materials, applications, MOQ, indicative price, lead time, certificates, downloadable brochure and inquiry button.

Example: Example listing: "SS316 centrifugal pump | 15 HP | 50 units MOQ | datasheet available | request quote."

3. Company profile

Business description, operating locations, years active, product range, contact methods, capacity, certifications and verification indicators.

Example: Example: buyer checks whether the profile names the legal entity and provides a matching business address and certificate details.

4. Inquiry / messaging

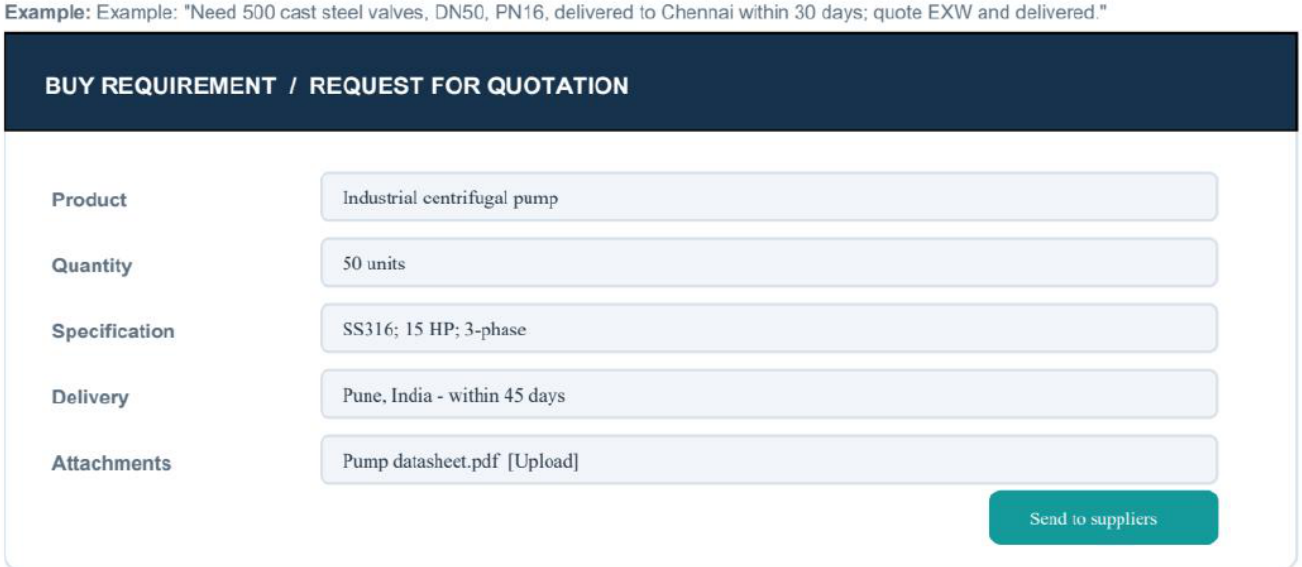
Direct message, contact request, attachment sharing, quote follow-up, inquiry status and response tracking.

Example: Example: request a quote and ask for a signed datasheet, lead time and validity period.

5. Requirement post / RFQ

A structured form for item, technical spec, quantity, budget, delivery location, date, Incoterm, attachments and quote deadline.

Example: Example: "Need 500 cast steel valves, DN50, PN16, delivered to Chennai within 30 days; quote EXW and delivered."



6. Quote comparison

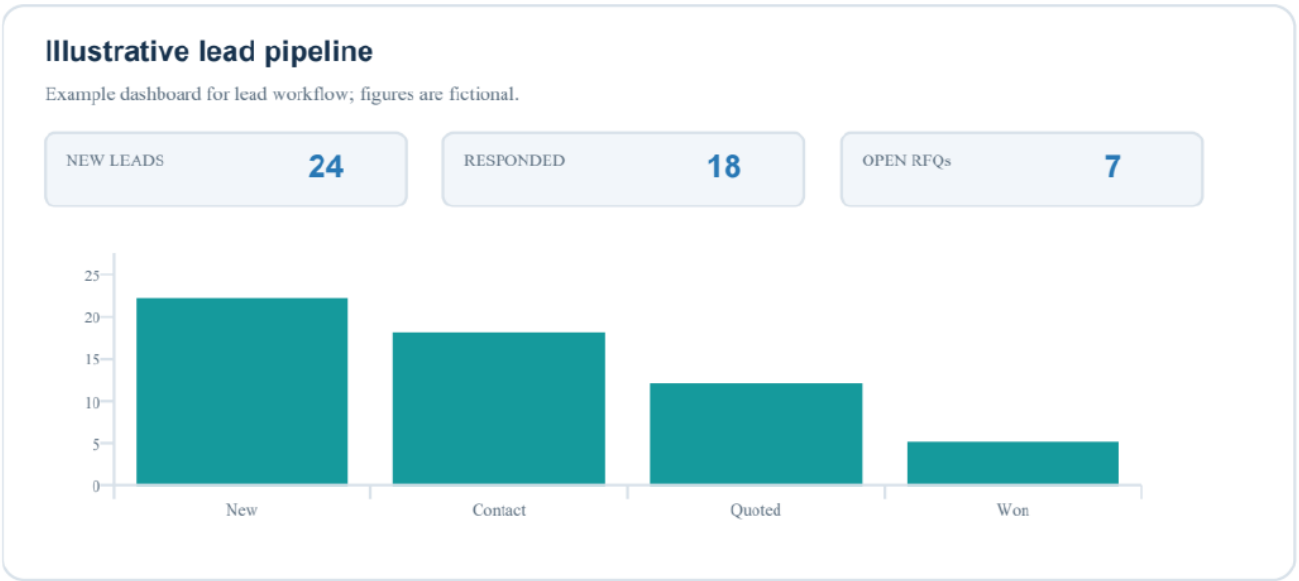
Compare suppliers side-by-side on price, MOQ, tooling, lead time, freight, payment, warranty, documents and response quality.

Example: Example: quote A has lower unit price but higher freight; compare total landed cost instead of unit price.

7. Lead inbox and seller CRM

Lead source, buyer need, assigned staff member, response status, reminders, notes, quote status and conversion tracking.

Example: Example stages: New > Contacted > Quoted > Negotiating > Won/Lost.



8. Verification and trust signals

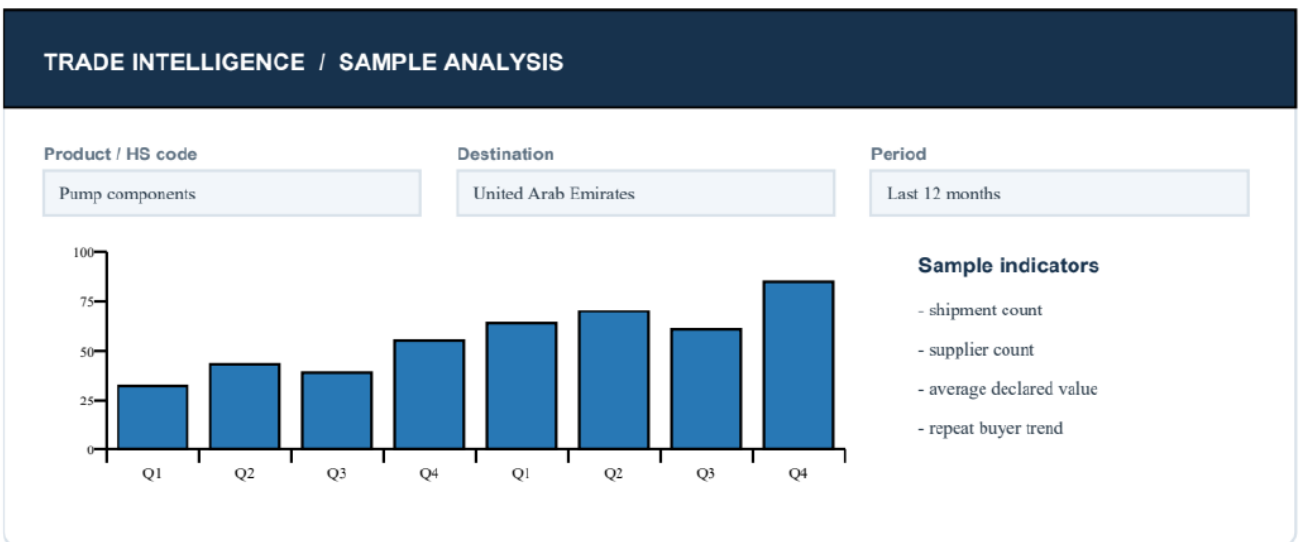
Identity, phone/email, business registration, tax ID, site visit or third-party checks may be shown. Badge scope differs.

Example: Example: record which document was checked, by whom and when; independently validate important credentials.

9. Trade data and market charts

Shipment count, value, product codes, origin/destination, company links, time series and market concentration.

Example: Example: a quarterly trend line shows shipment records rising while the number of repeat buyers remains flat.



10. Alerts and saved searches

Saved filters and notifications for new listings, matching RFQs, buyer changes, shipment activity or supplier updates.

Example: Example: receive a weekly alert when a target importer appears in recent shipment data.

11. Storefront / website

Business homepage, categorized catalogue, SEO-friendly pages, contact form, downloadable material, analytics and possibly checkout.

Example: Example: place the product catalogue URL on a quotation and QR code on an exhibition card.

12. Reports and export

Download or share inquiry reports, lead lists, shipment results, quotes, catalogue PDFs or dashboards.

Example: Example: export the last 90 days of RFQs and review response time by category.

13. Subscription and promotions

Free listing tiers and paid upgrades can change listing limits, placement, lead access, advertising, support or setup service.

Example: Example: compare expected qualified leads and annual fee; do not decide from badge or lead count alone.

14. Mobile / notifications

Mobile access, app alerts, chat, photo upload and inquiry response on the move may be available.

Example: Example: salesperson gets a new lead notification and replies with the correct product sheet.

15. Logistics / transaction tools

Depending on service: shipping estimates, payment, order tracking, dispute workflows, inspection or export support.

Example: Example: confirm who handles customs, insurance, bank charges and damage claims before order payment.

16. Unified search and AI discovery

Search products, HSN candidates, industries, seller names and barcodes; AI can parse a natural-language request into editable filters.

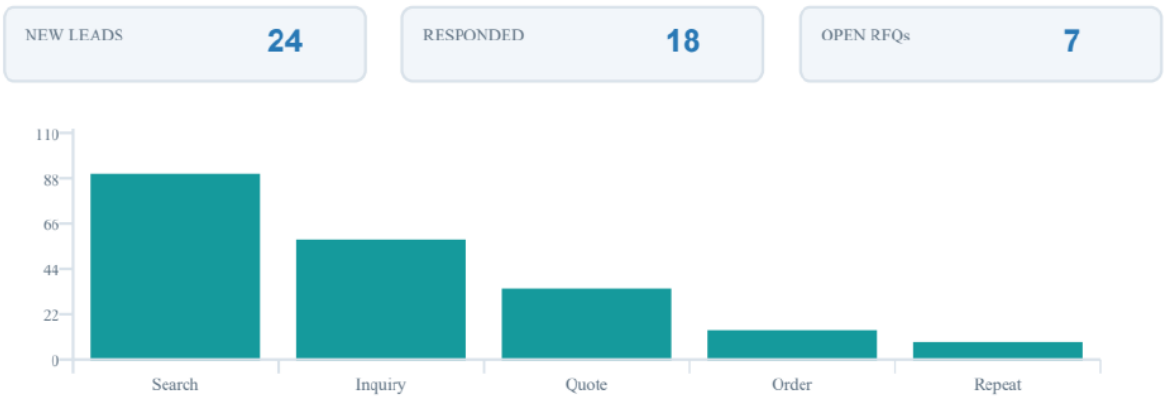
Example: Example: search “SS304 M12 bolts, 5,000 pieces near Chennai”; review the interpreted grade, size, quantity and location before seeing matches.

Charts and dashboard boards

Use the dashboard area to answer operational questions, not merely display totals. A useful board combines activity, quality, speed and outcome. The sample below uses fictional data.

Sample buyer/seller operations board

Fictional counts for an example funnel. A real dashboard should define each metric and date range.



Board	Recommended widgets	Question it answers
Buyer sourcing	Open RFQs, suppliers contacted, quotes received, quote completeness, delivery dates	Do we have enough comparable quotes to decide?
Seller lead management	New leads, response time, quote sent, follow-up due, won/lost	Which leads need a response today?
Trade intelligence	Shipments by month, buyer/supplier count, country split, price/value trend	Where is demand growing and who is buying?
Catalogue performance	Product views, inquiry clicks, top search terms, missing specs	Which listings need better content?
Service quality	First response time, ticket backlog, resolution time, reopen rate	Are user problems being resolved quickly?

Suggested chart set

Funnel: search > inquiry > quote > order. **Trend line:** inquiries or shipments by week/month. **Bar chart:** supplier response time by category. **Stacked bars:** RFQ outcomes by region. **Map:** source/destination countries. **Table:** supplier quote comparison. Always include date range, units, filters and source-data date.

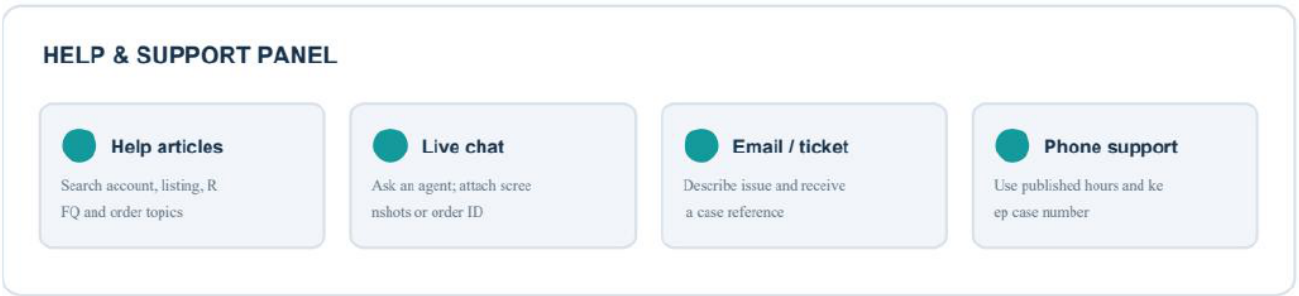
Example quote comparison board

Measure	Supplier 1	Supplier 2	Supplier 3
Unit price	INR 4,250	INR 4,060	INR 4,380
MOQ	50	100	25
Lead time	28 days	45 days	21 days
Freight to destination	INR 18,000	INR 12,000	INR 25,000
Documents confirmed	Partial	Yes	Pending
Decision note	Balanced option	Low unit price	Fastest delivery

Fictional comparison only. The lowest unit price is not automatically the lowest landed cost or the best fit.

Help, helpline and service features

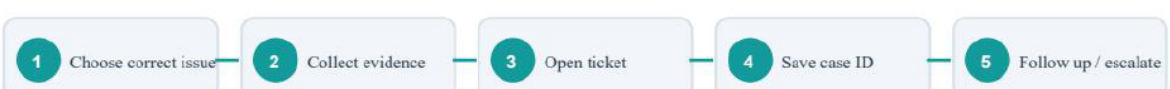
Support experiences vary. The options below are the contact patterns found in the platforms reviewed, represented without platform names. Always use the signed-in account's help menu or the platform's official contact page to confirm current phone numbers, hours and escalation routes.



Support option	Typical use	What to prepare	Example
Help centre / FAQ	Setup, profile, listing, password, subscription questions	Account email, screenshot, page name	Search "How do I update my product MOQ?"
Live chat	Quick account or workflow issue during service hours	Account ID, error text, order/RFQ reference	Ask why a posted RFQ is not visible.
Email / support ticket	Issue needing a record, attachments or follow-up	Timeline, invoice, screenshots, requested outcome	Submit duplicate billing evidence and keep ticket number.
Phone / helpline	Urgent access, account or sales service questions	Registered number and ticket number	Call the published support number and note date/time.
Dispute / complaint channel	Payment, delivery, counterfeit or policy concern	Platform order ID, contract, proof of payment, messages	Open a platform case promptly and retain all documents.
Callback / account manager	Paid plan, onboarding, ads, listing setup questions	Plan name, invoice, promised deliverables	Ask for package inclusions in writing before renewal.

Practical service workflow

How to get useful support



Helpline details reviewed

One marketplace's official help pages list telephone, helpdesk and live chat during stated business hours; the published phone details and hours should be rechecked before calling. Another marketplace exposes a Help Center with live chat, dispute, refund and after-sales routes. A trade-data service lists email/contact form as preferred and gives a response-time expectation. A SME platform publishes a support form and help centre; a business phone/email contact appears on its main site. For the domestic supplier marketplace, use the signed-in Help/Contact route and confirm the current official support number there.

Do not rely on phone numbers copied from old brochures, search snippets, ads or third-party directories. Never share an OTP or password with a support caller.

How to evaluate and use a platform safely

Marketplace listing quality varies. Use these checks before paying a supplier, buying a premium listing plan or relying on trade-data conclusions.

Supplier identity: Confirm legal name, registration, tax details, address and bank beneficiary match.

Product fit: Obtain a signed specification, drawing, sample or pre-production approval.

Quote scope: Confirm currency, taxes, packing, freight, Incoterm, delivery date, warranty and quote validity.

Payment: Use written payment milestones and only the agreed beneficiary; understand protection terms and exclusions.

Certifications: Check issuer, certificate number, scope, validity and whether it covers the exact product/site.

Lead quality: Track qualified inquiries, not just views, calls or raw lead counts.

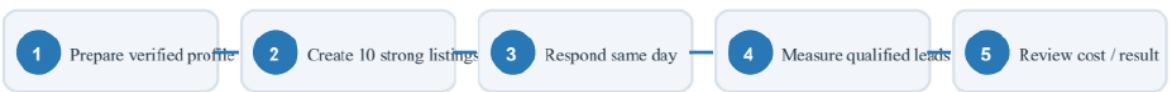
Trade data: Check HS code, data coverage, record date, declaration conventions and missing fields; independently validate prospects.

Paid membership: Request a written plan sheet covering lead volume, visibility, renewal, cancellation, taxes and refund rules.

Support: Save invoices, chats, screenshots, case IDs and dates; raise disputes within stated deadlines.

Suggested rollout for a small industrial supplier

First 30 days



A sample product listing checklist

Field	Good example	Why buyers need it
Product title	SS316 centrifugal pump, 15 HP, 3-phase	Makes the item searchable and specific
Specifications	Flow/head range, connection, seal, voltage, material	Confirms technical fit
Commercials	MOQ 10; quote on request; lead time 3-4 weeks	Lets buyer assess order fit
Evidence	Datasheet, test report, relevant certificates	Supports evaluation; buyer still verifies
Call to action	Send inquiry with quantity and destination	Creates a useful, actionable lead

Anonymous platform-by-platform checklist

This final view keeps the platform names out while mapping each platform type to a practical review checklist.

Review item	A	B	C	D	E
Main value	Find Indian sellers	Source globally	Indian trade leads	Shipment insight	Digital shopfront
First action	Search / post need	Search / RFQ	Search / post need	Choose product code	Create profile/catalogue
Key evidence	Supplier and product details	Spec, quote and protection terms	Supplier response and quote	Data coverage and records	Business verification and catalogue
Primary dashboard	Inquiries and calls	RFQs, quotes and orders	Buy leads and inquiries	Shipments and market trends	Views, leads and RFQs
Support route	Account Help / Contact	Buyer Help Center / online support	Helpdesk / chat / phone	Contact form / email	Help Centre / contact form
Main caution	Verify seller independently	Check terms, samples and landed cost	Lead quality varies	Data coverage can be incomplete	Plan inclusions vary

Sources and scope

The feature descriptions were prepared from the official product, how-it-works, feature, help-centre and contact pages reviewed on 30 September 2026. Anonymous source register: Platform A official marketplace and help pages; Platform B official buyer help, sourcing and seller pages; Platform C official how-it-works and help pages; Platform D official feature and contact pages; Platform E official marketplace, procurement and help pages. Public procurement material reviewed for sourcing patterns included supplier discovery, structured RFQs, quote comparison and assisted sourcing. The shipment control tower and transport operations described here are proposed additions, not a claim that those reference services already provide them. The report body deliberately omits company names and logos.

The buyer-contact flow is a product-design recommendation. It reflects the general need for a clear privacy notice and purpose when requesting personal data, plus the messaging platform requirement for a clear opt-in before a business initiates WhatsApp contact. Verify the applicable laws, commencement dates, notice language, retention and messaging policy with qualified reviewers before launch.

Feature and service pages are updated by their operators. This guide is a point-in-time functional overview, not a guarantee of plan inclusions, supplier verification, transaction results or customer service performance. The illustrated screens, dashboard metrics, examples and quote table are original fictional teaching examples.